

COMMUNITY AND REGIONAL PLANNING

Overview

<https://www.design.iastate.edu/academics/departments/crp/>

Community and regional planning are a field of study aimed at understanding the ever-changing socioeconomic and physical environments of our communities and planning for their future. Planners evaluate and seize opportunities to solve problems. Planners work at multiple levels of government, as well as the private sector, and they are concerned with issues that affect every corner of the world: the preservation and enhancement of the quality of life in a community, the protection of the environment, the promotion of equitable economic opportunities; and the management of growth and change of all kinds.

Graduates of the Urban Planning and Development department are able to integrate planning knowledge and skills in a variety of practical applications and can communicate effectively in written and oral form. Graduates will be qualified for a variety of entry-level positions in the public, private, and not-for-profit sectors. They will also be well prepared for graduate study in a variety of fields, including urban planning, law, public policy, public health, environmental science, geography, sociology, urban design, historic preservation, data science, and architecture.

Graduates of the Urban Planning and Development department are expected to understand the structure and functions of urban settlements, including the history of planning and urban development and the processes for plan and policy making. Graduates should have skills in problem formulation, quantitative analysis, written/oral and graphic communications, and collaboration, and in synthesizing and applying knowledge to practice. Graduates are expected to be able to assess the impact of plans and alternatives based on principles of equity and social justice, economic welfare and efficiency, environmental sustainability, and cultural heritage in the context of citizen involvement in decision making.

The department is a member of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning. The curriculum is accredited by the Planning Accreditation Board of the American Institute of Certified Planners. Our students gain an education that, when combined with experience, supports eligibility for membership in the American Institute of Certified Planners.

The department administers two undergraduate minors: Urban Studies and Geographic Information Science (GIS). The department cooperates in the undergraduate minors in Design Studies, Digital Media, Critical Studies in Design, Environmental Studies, and Sustainability.

Student Learning Outcomes

We educate students to be *critical thinkers and engaged global citizens who have the ability to contribute to a better world*. Graduates of the Urban

Planning and Development program at Iowa State University will be skilled in understanding and articulating community problems and issues and be able to apply planning knowledge in a diverse and democratic setting, to the standards of conduct outlined by the American Institute of Certified Planners.

Graduates of the program will:

- Demonstrate essential knowledge of the purpose and history of planning;
- Demonstrate knowledge of planning ethics, equity and social justice and be capable of making sound ethical judgments;
- Demonstrate knowledge of planning law and local government institutions regarding how plans and policies are developed and implemented;
- Be knowledgeable about the planning process; understand how social, cultural and economic forces influence land use changes; be able to develop alternative scenarios for the future; and have experience applying these ideas through active learning and real life experiences;
- Have a working knowledge of both qualitative and quantitative methods and demonstrate their ability to apply these methods in order to analyze a planning problem or situation;
- Engage communities, identify a range of tools that can be applied to different situations, and demonstrate their ability to expand participation, ensure inclusion, and give voice to diverse stakeholders;
- Demonstrate professional written, oral and visual communication skills within a variety of educational and community settings;
- Be knowledgeable about the natural environment and understand the factors that create sustainable and resilient communities;
- Be knowledgeable about diverse ideas, cultures and societies; and
- Have a basic knowledge about global issues that affect planning, urbanization, and societies.

Degree Requirements

The Department of Urban Planning and Development administers the 128-credit-hour undergraduate program leading to the Bachelor of Science. Students have the opportunity to work with their faculty advisors to define their own areas of interest, which may include a minor.

The B.S. in Community and Regional Planning program can be completed in two to four years. Students can declare a major in CRP at any time during their enrollment at Iowa State University. If applying by transfer from another program or institution, admission is based on the student's cumulative GPA and a departmental review of course work. Transfer applications from students in programs in anthropology, sociology, political science, history, geography, engineering, and other related disciplines are encouraged. Community and Regional Planning

emphasizes responsibility and citizenship, writing and analytical ability, and critical thinking.

Total Degree Requirement: 128 credits

Only 65 credits from a two-year institution may apply which may include up to 16 technical credits; 9 P-NP credits of free electives; 2.00 minimum GPA; completion of all requirements listed below.

International Perspective: 3 credits

U.S. Cultures and Communities: 3 credits

Communication: 13 credits

6 credits of either Communications, Humanities, Social Sciences or Math/Sciences need to be at the 3000-level or above.

(C or better grade in ENGL 1500 and ENGL 2500)

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
ENGL 3090	Proposal and Report Writing	3
or ENGL 3140	Technical Communication	
SPCM 2120	Fundamentals of Public Speaking	3
LIB 1600	Introduction to College Level Research	1
Total Credits		13

Humanities: 9 credits

PHIL 2010	Introduction to Philosophy	3
or PHIL 2060	Introduction to Logic and Scientific Reasoning	
or PHIL 2300	Moral Theory and Practice	
Six credits from program curriculum sheet		6
Total Credits		9

Social Sciences: 18 credits

ECON 1010	Principles of Microeconomics	3
or ECON 1020	Principles of Macroeconomics	
POLS 1110	Introduction to American Government	3
SOC 1340	Introduction to Sociology	3
Nine credits from program curriculum sheet.		9
Total Credits		18

Math/Physics/Biol. Sciences: 13 credits

STAT 1010	Principles of Statistics	4
6 credits in Natural Sciences		6
3 credits in Math		3
Total Credits		13

Design Core: 3 credits

DSNS 1020	Design Studio I	3-4
or DSNS 1830	Design in Context	
Total Credits		3-4

Community and Regional Planning Core: 28 credits

CRP 2010	The City in American History	3
CRP 2930	Environmental Planning	3
CRP 3010	Urban Analytical Methods	4
CRP 3020	Plan Analysis and the Development Process	3
CRP 3830	Theory of the Planning Process	3
CRP 3910	Field Travel	1
CRP 4320	Urban Planning Studio	6
CRP 4920	Planning Law, Administration and Implementation	3
CRP 3310	Professional Practice Seminar	2
Total Credits		28

Planning Elective: 24 credits

24 credits from:

CRP 2510	Fundamentals of Geographic Information Systems	3
CRP 2910	World Cities and Globalization	3
CRP 3200	Urban Geography	3
CRP 3250	Introduction to Housing	3
CRP 3510	Geospatial Analysis and Visualization	3
CRP 3760	Rural, Urban and Regional Economics	3
CRP 4160	Urban Design and Practice	6
CRP 4170	Urban Revitalization	3
CRP 4210	Financing Historic Preservation Projects	3
CRP 4290	Planning in Developing Countries	3
CRP 4350	Planning in Small Towns	3
CRP 4360	Community Economic Development	3
CRP 4370	Public Participation in Planning	3
CRP 4420	Site Development	3
CRP 4450	Transportation Policy and Planning	3
CRP 4490	Geodesign: Planning for Sustainable Futures	3
CRP 4520	Geographic Data Management and Planning Analysis	3
CRP 4570	Serious GeoGames	3
CRP 4590X	Geospatial Techniques for Nature-Based Solutions	3
CRP 4600	Social Justice and Planning	3
CRP 4710	Real Estate Development	3
CRP 4790	Public Finance and Planning	3
CRP 4840	Sustainable Communities	3
CRP 4910	Environmental Law and Planning	3
CRP 4940	Senior Seminar in Planning	3
CRP 5110	Documenting the Historic Built Environment	3-4
CRP 5210	Historic Preservation Planning: Theory and Practice	3

General Electives: 20 credits

20 credits of general electives from program curriculum sheet

Community and Regional Planning, B.S.

First Year

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
DSNS 1020 or 1830	3-4 Math/Science	3
ENGL 1500	3 SPCM 2120	3
ECON 1010 or 1020	3 PHIL 2010, 2060, or 2300	3
SOC 1340	3 Natural Sciences	3
Elective	3 Elective	3
LIB 1600	1	
16-17		15

Second Year

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
CRP 2930	3 CRP 3010	4
CRP 2010	3 CRP 3910	1-2
STAT 1010	4 Soc. Science/Humanities Elective	6
ENGL 2500	3 Humanities Elective	3
POLS 1110	3 Elective	3
16		17-18

Third Year

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
CRP 3020	3 CRP 4920	3
CRP 3830	3 Planning Elective	6
ENGL 3090 or 3140	3 Soc. Science/Humanities Elective	3
Soc. Science/Humanities Elective	3 CRP 3310	2
Elective	3 CRP 3910	1
15		15

Fourth Year

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
CRP 4320	6 Planning Elective or Option Studio	6
Planning Elective	3 Planning Elective	3
3000-4000 Elective	3 Planning Elective	3
3000-4000 Elective	3 Planning Elective	3
	3000-4000 Elective	3
15		18

Undergraduate Minors

The Department of Urban Planning and Development offers 15-credit minors in Urban Studies and Geographic Information Science (GISC).

Urban Studies

The undergraduate minor in Urban Studies introduces students to the principles of urban development, land use, public engagement, and sustainable planning. Designed to complement a wide range of majors, this minor equips students with the knowledge and skills to understand, shape, and manage cities, towns, and regions effectively. Open to undergraduates from all disciplines, this minor is especially relevant for students interested in careers in urban planning, urban design, architecture, public policy, real estate development, environmental management, transportation, and public administration.

This minor requires 15 credit hours of coursework. At least 9 credits must be taken in courses numbered 2000 and above, of which 6 of those credits must be in courses numbered 3000 and above. At least 6 of the 9 credits in non-required courses must be CRP designated courses. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement.

I. Requirements (6 Credits):

CRP 2010	The City in American History	3
CRP 3830	Theory of the Planning Process	3

II. Additional CRP Courses (9 credits):

Any CRP designated course, excluding CRP 3300, CRP 3310, CRP 3910, or CRP 4320.

At least 6 credits must be in courses numbered 3000 and above.

Geographic Information Science

The Geographic Information Science (GISC) minor is earned by taking CRP 2510, plus 12 additional credits from the approved list of courses. At least 9 credit hours must be in courses numbered 2000 or above at Iowa State, of which at least 6 credits are in courses numbered 3000 or above. The College of Design requires students to earn a C or higher in at least 6 of the required 3000-level credits. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used in any other department, college or university requirement except the credit requirement for graduation. The GIS minor is open to students in any college and any major.

INTROduction: 3 credits

CRP 2510	Fundamentals of Geographic Information Systems	3
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GIS Tools and Techniques: 3 credits

CRP 3510	Geospatial Analysis and Visualization	3
LA 3020	Ecological Design	6
ENSCI 2700	Geospatial Technologies	3
GEOL 4520	Intro GIS for Geoscientists	3

NREM 3450	Natural Resource Photogrammetry and Geographic Information Systems	3
GIS Applications: 9 credits		
ABE 4370	Watershed Modeling and Policy	3
CRP 4490	Geodesign: Planning for Sustainable Futures	3
or CRP 5490	Geodesign: Planning for Sustainable Futures	
CRP 4520	Geographic Data Management and Planning Analysis	3
CRP 4540	Fundamentals of Remote Sensing and Spatial Analysis	3
CRP 4550	Smart and Sustainable Cities	3
CRP 4560	GIS Programming and Automation	3
CRP 4570	Serious GeoGames	3
or CRP 5570	Serious GeoGames	
CRP 4590X	Geospatial Techniques for Nature-Based Solutions	3
CRP 5580	Web Mapping and Spatial Data Visualization	3
GEOL 4680	Applied Geostatistics for Geoscientists	3
GEOL 4880	Raster GIS for Geoscientists	3
GEOL 4890	Survey of Remote Sensing Technologies	3
NREM 4460	Integrating GPS and GIS for Natural Resource Management	3

Graduate Programs

The Department of Urban Planning and Development offers three different graduate degree options for individuals interested in engaging with communities and helping to shape their future: a Master of Community and Regional Planning (MCRP), an interdisciplinary Master of Science with an emphasis in Community Development (CDEV), and a Master of Real Estate Development (MRED).

Master of Community and Regional Planning

The primary focus of the MCRP degree is to prepare students with the education and practical skills to be leaders in the practice of planning. The program of graduate study is accredited by the Planning Accreditation Board of the American Institute of Certified Planners. The program is STEM-designated.

Degree requirements include completion of a 2-year, 49-credit program, including a required core (25 credits), electives (18-21 credits), and a capstone component consisting of either a comprehensive exam (CRP 5980 Comprehensive Exam Preparation, 3 credits) or thesis (CRP 6990 Thesis Research, 6 credits). The required core consists of CRP 5010, 5320, 5610, 5630, 5640, 5660, 5680 and 5920. Students select electives in consultation with their Program of Study Committee (POSC). Students are encouraged to complete an internship in a planning office during their course of study.

CRP 5010	The Practice of Planning	1
CRP 5320	Urban Planning Studio	6
CRP 5610	Planning Theory	3
CRP 5630	Planning the American Metropolis	3
CRP 5640	Introduction to Analytical Methods for Planning	3
CRP 5660	Policy Analysis and Planning	3
CRP 5680	Planning and Development	3
CRP 5920	Land Use and Development Regulation Law	3

Admission to the MCRP program is by application to the department and to the Graduate College. Students with a bachelor's degree in planning or students who have taken highly relevant coursework may be able to waive up to 9 credits of course requirements. Students must petition the department's Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) in writing prior to the first day class of the student's first semester in the program to have credits waived. No foreign language is required for the degree Master of Community and Regional Planning.

Double Degree Programs

Double degree programs are offered with architecture (MCRP/MArch), business administration (MCRP/MBA), landscape architecture (MCRP/MLA) and sustainable agriculture (MCRP/MS). Information about our programs and how to apply can be obtained from the department's web page at: <https://www.design.iastate.edu/academics/departments/crp/> or send an email to crp@iastate.edu.

Master of Community Development

The Master of Community Development (MCD) program is an online degree designed to educate students to become community developers and civic leaders who could bring about positive community change. Graduates of the Community Development program at Iowa State University will be skilled in understanding and articulating community problems, issues, and opportunities. Students will have the knowledge and skills to plan and facilitate community action. The MCD degree is designed for working professionals and nontraditional students through online learning. Degree requirements included completion of a 2-year, 30-credit program including a required core (15 credits) and electives (15 credits). The required core includes a capstone 3-credit practicum (COMDV 5300) and COMDV 5020, COMDV 5030, COMDV 5040, and COMDV 5050.

COMDV 5020	Theories and Constructs of Community Change	3
COMDV 5030	Community Development Methods	3
COMDV 5040	Creating Community Change	3
COMDV 5050	Analysis of the Community Economy	3
COMDV 5300	Community Development Practicum	3

Admission to the MCD program is through the Department of Urban Planning and Development and the Graduate College. A bachelor's degree

from an accredited institution of higher education is required. Up to nine credits of course requirements may be waived with relevant coursework. Students may petition the program's Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) in writing prior to the first day of class in the student's first semester in the program to have credits waived. Further information on the MCD program can be found on the department's web site at: <https://www.design.iastate.edu/community-and-regional-planning/degrees/master-of-community-development/>. (<https://www.design.iastate.edu/community-and-regional-planning/degrees/master-of-community-development/>)

Master of Real Estate Development

In partnership with the Department of Finance in the College of Business, CRP offers a two-year, 33-credit Master of Real Estate Development (MRED) degree. The program is designed for working professionals, with coursework delivered in a blended online/on-campus format. During the academic year, students can complete coursework remotely and come to campus for three, one-week intensive workshops throughout the two-year degree. More information on the MRED program is available on the program website: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/master-of-real-estate-development/>.

Graduate Certificates

The Certificate in Preservation and Cultural Heritage (P+CH) is a multidisciplinary graduate program that provides the practical skills and background needed to succeed in the fields of historic preservation and cultural resource management. The certificate program is open to Iowa State University graduate students in any College of Design major as well as those majoring in history, anthropology, and related disciplines. Interested students should visit <https://www.design.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/preservation-and-cultural-heritage-certificate/> or contact historicplaces@iastate.edu for guidance.

The department also offers a 13-credit graduate certificate in Geographic Information Systems (GIS) in spatial analysis, GIS applications, and program management. The program is open to graduate students in all disciplines of the university. Information about the graduate certificate may be obtained from the department office and from the department's web page at: <https://www.design.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/geographic-information-systems-certificate/>.